

Jul 1, 2026

Meeting Jul 1, 2026 at 20:30 PST

Meeting records  Transcript

Summary

The team aligned on technical infrastructure and store deployment strategies to ensure a rapid product launch.

Mobile App Deployment Strategy

The team evaluated deployment strategies, favoring web application alternatives alongside native mobile development to manage release timelines effectively. Railway serves as the primary host for backend infrastructure.

System Security and Features

Operational discussions centered on implementing adaptive pricing logic and mandatory identification for delivery transactions. Security architecture will rely on rate limiting and optimized server configurations for traffic.

Project Governance and Planning

Development is targeting the testing phase for the upcoming week. Progress remains aligned on major operational requirements over secondary feature additions.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Franz's account for initial release** The team will utilize Franz's Google Play Console account for the initial application launch to facilitate faster deployment, with plans to transfer to the Cartman PH account at a later time.
- **iOS web app for temporary access** A web app version is established as the temporary solution for iOS users to access services while the native iOS app is being finalized.
- **Railway selected as hosting provider** Railway is selected as the primary hosting provider for the application, based on its capability to host databases and its pay-as-you-go model.
- **Premium features deferred to future releases** The implementation of premium 'Cartman Pro' features is deferred to allow the team to focus on core operational functionalities for the initial launch.
- **Phone number verification mandated** Phone number verification via SIM registration is mandated for customer accounts to prevent fraudulent activity and improve tracking.
- **Mandatory valid ID for COD** The system will require users to submit a valid ID to proceed with Cash on Delivery (COD) transactions.
- **Addition of drop-off points feature** Riders are granted the functionality to input additional drop-off points or addresses within the system.
- **Threshold-based delivery fee structure** The delivery fee calculation logic is established as a global threshold-based system.
- **Support ticket and override system** The platform will implement support tickets to enable account overrides after confirmation.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

- ☐ [Benjamin Ford Cepe] Research Organization Account: Investigate the requirements for creating a business organization account on Google and Apple to bypass testing requirements.
- ☐ [Louie Dale Cervera] Compare Hosting Services: Conduct a thorough cost analysis of Render versus Railway to determine the optimal hosting provider.
- ☐ [Louie Dale Cervera] Connect Backend: Complete the final checks on the backend and integrate it with the front end application within 1 week.
- ☐ [Teddie John Rajeev] Invite Collaborator: Grant access to the relevant project environments to Louie Dale Cervera to facilitate development.
- ☐ [Louie Dale Cervera] Research Authentication: Investigate the implementation details for 2 factor authentication and email based OTP verification.
- ☐ [Benjamin Ford Cepe] Require ID Verification: Implement logic necessitating submission of valid identification documents to proceed with Cash on Delivery transactions.
- ☐ [The group] Prepare iOS: Develop the platform to ensure it is production ready for Apple devices.
- ☐ [The group] Ready Play Store: Finalize the application build to ensure it meets deployment requirements for the Android marketplace.
- ☐ [The group] Improve Profiling: Create advanced features for administrative dashboards to track and categorize platform users effectively.
- ☐ [The group] Add Dropoff Points: Enable riders to input specific locations for delivery destinations within the mapping interface.
- ☐ [Benjamin Ford Cepe] Share Brand Kit: Provide logos and marketing icons to team members for use in interface designs.
- ☐ [Louie Dale Cervera] Breakdown Pricing: Calculate delivery fees and cost allocations to establish a clear structure for platform transactions.
- ☐ [The group] Schedule Meetings: Conduct project progress syncs every Monday Wednesday and Friday.
- ☐ [Teddie John Rajeev] Build Support Tickets: Develop a system that allows users to request account assistance and enables administrators to perform manual overrides after confirmation.
- ☐ [The group] Implement Monitoring: Set up systems for comprehensive tracking of application health and operational performance.

Details

- **Team Project Status:** The team discussed the current status of their individual development projects. Benjamin Ford Cepe inquired about existing project workloads, and participants confirmed they have completed or paused other commitments, such as CS and Kartman, leaving them available for new development tasks ([00:03:27](#)).
- **Market and Competitive Landscape:** Benjamin Ford Cepe provided an update on the current market environment, identifying Coco Express, Food Panda, and Grab as competitors for their deployment. Despite the competitive presence, they are maintaining over 300 transactions per day, and they plan to transition users to the new platform immediately upon launch ([00:05:15](#)).
- **Launch Timeline and Strategy:** Benjamin Ford Cepe proposed a launch window of 7 to 10 days to prevent losing merchants and customers. The team discussed the necessity of preparing for both Android and iOS environments, acknowledging that they must account for the required testing periods for the Google Play Store and Apple App Store ([00:07:50](#)).
- **Google Play Store and iOS App Store Deployment:** Franz Eliezer Samilo confirmed that they are in the process of applying for a Google Play Console account to facilitate faster updates ([00:10:17](#)). Regarding the 14-day testing requirement for public release, the team explored the possibility of using private links and testers to streamline the process ([00:12:02](#)).
- **Beta Testing and Deployment Options:** Teddie John Rajeev suggested utilizing TestFlight for iOS beta builds as an alternative to a production release, as it allows for controlled testing ([00:13:35](#)). For the Android platform, the team discussed the possibility of using an APK for initial release while managing the Play Store deployment through Franz Eliezer Samilo's account, with the option to transfer it later to the official Cartman account ([00:16:21](#)).
- **Organization Account Registration:** To bypass the 14-day testing and verification requirements for app stores, Teddie John Rajeev proposed setting up an organization account, which would formally recognize the entity. Benjamin Ford Cepe agreed to research the document requirements to proceed with this approach ([00:18:01](#)).

- **iOS Web App Solution:** The team discussed building a web app as a temporary solution for iOS users while they work toward a native release ([00:19:33](#)) ([00:22:40](#)). Louie Dale Cervera noted that while native features like location detection might be limited on a web app, it would remain functional for ordering ([00:19:33](#)) ([00:24:30](#)). Benjamin Ford Cepe supported this, noting that other platforms like Food Panda offer web-based ordering ([00:22:40](#)).
- **Development Stack and Cross-Platform Tools:** Louie Dale Cervera confirmed that the current system is built using Flutter, which allows for cross-platform deployment ([00:24:30](#)). When discussing the use of Docker, the team clarified that it is intended for maintaining consistency in the development environment rather than for production app exports ([00:26:37](#)). They agreed to prioritize native APK/mobile development first before transitioning to web app versions ([00:28:08](#)).
- **Backend Progress and Hosting:** Louie Dale Cervera estimated the backend development to be 20-35% complete and committed to finishing it within one week ([00:29:45](#)) ([00:34:24](#)). Regarding hosting, the team compared options like Render and Railway, with the consensus leaning toward Railway because it serves as a complete package with a pay-as-you-go model ([00:31:09](#)).
- **Rider Allocation Logic:** The team discussed the algorithm for rider allocation, which will prioritize orders based on weighted variables, including distance, the number of active operations, and the rider's successful order history ([00:35:37](#)). They aim for an adaptive threshold for order distribution rather than relying on a fixed, inflexible limit ([00:39:06](#)).
- **Order Management and Interactions:** Benjamin Ford Cepe and Louie Dale Cervera discussed the order workflow, including grace periods for modifications, and the ability for merchants to cancel orders if items are out of stock ([00:43:15](#)). They plan to implement global variables to manage rider penalties for repeated declined orders ([00:46:47](#)).
- **Authentication and Security:** The team reviewed login and security measures, including the potential implementation of Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) and email verification for password resets ([00:46:47](#)). Teddie John Rajeev noted that using email services for these purposes has free tier limits, such as 3,000 emails per month, which should be sufficient ([00:50:22](#)).

- **Future Feature Planning:** The team clarified that there are currently no in-app purchase features implemented. While they discussed the potential for a "Cartman Pro" subscription version in the future, they agreed to delay such features to focus on major operational requirements first ([00:51:30](#)).
- **User Verification and Fraud Prevention:** To prevent fraud, the team discussed the necessity of collecting valid phone numbers and performing OTP verification ([00:54:43](#)). They also considered requiring national IDs for verification, though they noted the need to further define the business terms, agreements, and legalities regarding data collection ([00:56:11](#)).
- **Cash on Delivery Validation:** The team discussed the process for handling Cash on Delivery (COD) transactions, noting that users must submit a valid identification to proceed. Benjamin Ford Cepe proposed that while there will be a skip button during the initial registration process, the system must trigger a pop-up prompt requiring the submission of a valid ID specifically when a user attempts to finalize a COD transaction ([00:59:11](#)).
- **Server Infrastructure and API Security:** For backend operations, Benjamin Ford Cepe determined that a single server based in Singapore is sufficient to handle current user volume within the Philippines without requiring a massive Content Delivery Network. To address security, the team discussed using standard API keys and implementing rate limiting to protect against spam and prevent users from exposing or deconstructing API endpoints ([01:00:51](#)).
- **Future System Expansion and Development:** The team outlined plans for upcoming project phases, including preparing for iOS compatibility, a production-ready Google Play Store launch, and enhanced user profiling within an admin dashboard. The development team is currently focused on identifying and addressing potential loopholes regarding order logistics and customer validation ([01:02:52](#)).
- **Mapping Services and Tracking:** The conversation covered the implementation of GPS tracking and mapping services, with Louie Dale Cervera confirming that the project is currently using OpenStreetMap. The team discussed the challenges of handling mapping for private properties or uncharted routes and the difficulty of implementing UI animations for tracking, given the reliance on third-party tile map data ([01:05:37](#)).
- **Rider Drop-off Points:** Benjamin Ford Cepe identified a limitation in the current rider system where riders cannot add custom addresses or specific drop-off points beyond preloaded locations. The team agreed to implement

a feature that allows for additional drop-off fields to give riders more flexibility, even if the underlying mapping data from OpenStreetMap is less granular than Google Maps ([01:08:12](#)).

- **API Pricing Constraints:** The team addressed the potential costs associated with mapping services, specifically noting that Google Maps API requires payment for geocoding requests. Benjamin Ford Cepe and Louie Dale Cervera agreed to prioritize cost-effective routing and threshold-based logic over reliance on expensive external geocoding services ([01:10:19](#)).
- **Merchant Order Management:** The team discussed how merchants handle incoming orders, noting that small local shops do not require dedicated point-of-sale terminals and can manage orders directly through the mobile application. There is ongoing investigation into whether the system should support printing orders as PDFs for larger merchants ([01:12:50](#)).
- **Delivery Fee Logic and Adaptive Thresholds:** The team discussed the current delivery fee model, which uses a flag-down rate for a 2 km radius. Benjamin Ford Cepe proposed moving this logic to a global variable in the admin dashboard, allowing for "adaptive" pricing based on distance thresholds that can be customized or adjusted on the fly, rather than relying solely on static calculations ([01:14:56](#)).
- **Admin Access and System Overrides:** Teddie John Rajeev and Benjamin Ford Cepe discussed the necessity of an operational admin dashboard to monitor logs and performance ([01:18:32](#)). To manage account issues, they agreed to prepare override mechanisms—such as remote password resets or authentication bypasses—that can be executed by the team via support tickets after user confirmation ([01:19:57](#)).
- **Operational Dashboard and Caching:** Benjamin Ford Cepe emphasized the need for an operational dashboard to oversee active riders, system health, and end-to-end monitoring ([01:21:25](#)). To optimize performance, the team discussed using a Flutter "image network" package to handle the caching of merchant images, which reduces the processing burden on both the client device and the server ([01:23:20](#)).
- **Monetization and Marketing Assets:** The team touched on future monetization strategies, such as offering a "Pro plan" for merchants that includes promotional activities and higher visibility on the platform. Marketing assets, including logos and brand kits, are being managed by a dedicated team ([01:25:10](#)).

- **Meeting Cadence and Progress Tracking:** To maintain development momentum, the team agreed to schedule recurring meetings every Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. This schedule will allow for consistent progress updates and help manage the pressure of upcoming deadlines ([01:29:00](#)).
- **Financial Support and Testing Timeline:** Benjamin Ford Cepe confirmed that financial support is available for the team to cover development costs and server needs. The current project timeline aims to move into the testing phase near the end of the following week ([01:32:06](#)).

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